GolfBot: Autonomous robot for Divot Detection and Repair

Teodor Donchev

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Maynooth University
Faculty of Science and Engineering
Electronic Engineering Department

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Head of the Department: Prof. Gerard Lacey
Supervisor: Prof. Gerard Lacey

Abstract

Maintaining high-quality golf courses requires regular divot repairs, which is a slow, repetitive, and tiring job for maintenance workers. The GolfBot project proposes an autonomous robot to identify and fix divots on golf courses, addressing the need for a more efficient and automated solution in turf management.

This project, GolfBot, is an autonomous vehicle built upon the Wumpus platform, enhanced with specialized hardware and software to perform its task. The robot uses advanced computer vision techniques, including a custom-trained object detection model for real-time divot identification and a 3D depth camera for accurately measuring divot dimensions. For navigation, it is equipped with RTK GPS modules for precise positioning. The mechanical repair mechanism consists of a hopper with a motor-screw mechanism for dispensing a sand-seed mixture, and rubber brushes for uniform spreading. The entire system is controlled using ROS2, with components developed in Python and C++.

The result of this project is a functional prototype of an autonomous divot-repairing robot. This thesis documents the design, implementation, and evaluation of the GolfBot, demonstrating its capability to improve the quality and efficiency of golf course maintenance.

Declaration

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Introduction

You can cite like this [1] for number only or you can cite like this for the author: Di Carlo et al. [1].

1.1 Motivation

1.2 Problem Statement

1.3 The GolfBot System

1.4 Thesis Outline

The following chapters will detail the project.

- **Chapter 2: Literature Review** will survey existing work on autonomous robots in agriculture and turf maintenance, divot detection techniques, and automated repair systems.
- **Chapter 3: Design** will present the overall design of the GolfBot, covering both the hardware and software architectures.
- **Chapter 4: Implementation** will provide a detailed account of the implementation of the GolfBot's main components: the computer vision system, the navigation system, the mechanical dispenser, and the graphical user interface.

- **Chapter 5: Experimental Results** will describe the experiments conducted to validate the performance of the GolfBot and present the results.
- **Chapter 6: Future Work** will discuss potential enhancements and future research directions for the GolfBot project.
- **Chapter 7: Conclusion** will summarize the project, highlighting its contributions and concluding remarks.

Chapter 2

Literature Review

2.1 Autonomous Robots in Turf Maintenance

2.2 Divot Detection and Analysis

2.3 Automated Repair Mechanisms

2.4 Summary

Chapter 3

Design

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3.1.1 Hardware Architecture

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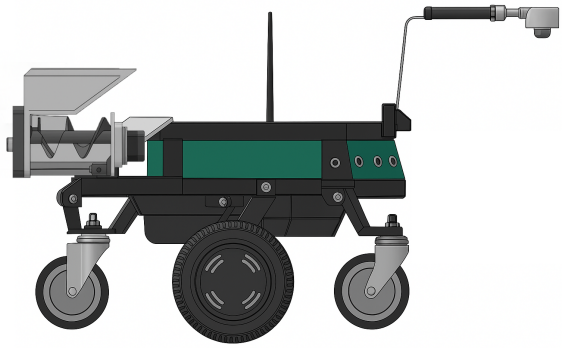

Figure 3.1: GolfBot System Diagram

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Chapter 7

Conclusion

7.1 Summary of Work

7.2 Contributions

Appendix A

Name

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[1] J. Di Carlo, P. M. Wensing, B. Katz, G. Bledt, and S. Kim, "Dynamic Locomotion in the MIT Cheetah 3 Through Convex Model-Predictive Control," in *2018 IEEE/RSJ International Conference on Intelligent Robots and Systems (IROS)*, Oct. 2018, pp. 1–9.